



Business Studies

Communication

ANJULA UDANI

GCE ADVANCED LEVEL ENGLISH MEDIUM

Lesson 8 - Communication

- Communication can be defined as sending and receiving information, understanding and sharing information from one party to another or many parties.
- Communication is important for business activities as well as social activities.

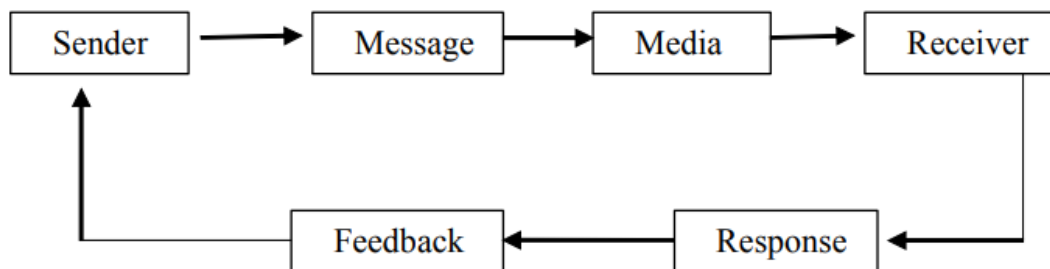
The Importance of Communication for Business Activities

- ❖ To exchange ideas between parties at businesses.
- ❖ To maintain employer employee relationship.
- ❖ To manage human and physical resources well.
- ❖ For marketing promotional activities.

The Importance of Communication for Social Activities

- ❖ To exchange ideas and messages socially.
- ❖ To know instantly about the incidents that happen internationally.
- ❖ To get information needed for educational activities.
- ❖ To know about new inventions that come with technological improvement.
- ❖ To build up social relationships nationally and internationally

- Communication process can be shown in a diagram as follows.



The Elements of the Communication Process

- ❖ Sender
 - This is the party sending the message. If it is verbal the sender is a speaker or a lecturer, if it is written form then it is the person who signs it or the institution.
- ❖ Message
 - The information that the sender provides to the receiver.
- ❖ Media

- How can the information be provided? This is the communication mode used to provide information.

Examples -: Verbal medium, written medium.

- ❖ Receiver
 - This is the person who grasps the message. He can be a reader, listener or viewer.
- ❖ Response
 - The way the receiver acts on what he heard or read.
- ❖ Feed back
 - This is the response from the receiver to the sender of the message ensuring that he received and understood the message.

Characteristics that should be in Effective Communication.

- ❖ Correctness
- ❖ Brevity
- ❖ Completeness
- ❖ Clarity
- ❖ Politeness
- ❖ Certainty
- ❖ Consideration
- ❖ Cost
- ❖ Speed

Key Considerations for Preparing a Message

- ❖ The nature of the message
- ❖ Completeness
- ❖ Correctness
- ❖ Politeness
- ❖ The ability of being understood by the receiver
- ❖ Brevity
- ❖ Certainty

Communication medias are categorized as follows

- ❖ Oral media
- ❖ Written media
- ❖ Signs and symbols media

- It can also be categorized as follows in the way communication takes place in an organization.
 - ❖ Internal communication
 - ❖ External communication
- Internal communication is the exchange of information among the different parties within a business organization.
- In internal communication, exchange of various information takes place.
 - ❖ Among managers – owners
 - ❖ Among employees – employees
 - ❖ Among departments – departments
- External communication means the exchange of information by the business organization with external organizations and external parties.
- In external communication, exchange of information takes place.
 - ❖ Among business organizations – customers
 - ❖ Among business organizations – other business organizations and suppliers.
- Given below are some examples of ways that communication is done through various communication media.

Verbal	Internal	Electronic	Intercom
		Non - electronic	Face to face interviews, conferences, internal meetings
Written	External	Electronic	Telephone, mobile phones, loud speakers, voice mail
		Non - electronic	Drum, public meetings
	Internal	Electronic	Electronic notice board, E-mail
		Non - electronic	Memos, notices, notice boards, reports
Signs and symbols	External	Electronic	Fax, E-mail, electronic notice boards, SMS
		Non - electronic	Letters, newspapers, magazines, banners, posters, gazettes
	Internal	Electronic	Electronic bell, internal warning signals
		Non - electronic	Bell, road signs, map depicting the location of the organisation, directional foot prints
	External	Electronic	Warning sirens, colour lights, ambulance siren
		Non - electronic	Packing symbols, railway and road signals, signs used for deaf, decisions of sports umpires, body movements of traffic officers

Electronic Communication

- Communication that has been generated with the development of information and communication technology is known as electronic communication.
 - A few modern electronic communication methods can be explained as follows.
- ❖ Internet
 - A computer network that covers a wide range or a computer network that is available internationally.
 - It can be described as the network of networks.
 - Here, the information that is entered from various places can be obtained through a personal computer.
 - ❖ E-mail
 - Exchange of messages through internet from a computer to another computer is known as email.
 - To send a message that is prepared electronically, the sender and the receiver both should have internet facilities and email addresses.
 - ❖ Intranet
 - An institutional network based on the internet, which has been facilitated to reach the data within the institute.
 - This is a network that is under the control of a person, or an institute and the service provided by this is available only for authorized persons.
 - ❖ Voice mail
 - This is a system where the message given by the sender verbally over the phone is reflected through a network and is stored or recorded on a disk to retrieve later.
 - ❖ Fax
 - An electronic machine that enables us to transmit letters and documents with pictures instantly through an ordinary telephone system is known as a fax machine.
 - In a fax method, the fax machine that sends the message gets the print of the relevant documents through digital technology and transmits it to the fax machine which receives it.
 - ❖ Mobile phones
 - As a result of the development of communication technology at present, mobile phones are used to do various business activities through satellite technology.
 - ❖ Intercom

- A telephone network installed privately to exchange information within the organization through the telephone networks.

Barriers for Effective Communication

- ❖ Poor knowledge about the use of modern technical methods.
- ❖ External barriers occur in the use of communication equipment.
- ❖ Use of outdated communication systems.
- ❖ Barriers that occur in the process of communication means.
- ❖ Weaknesses that exist in communication plans.
- ❖ Language problems, knowledge and attitudes
- ❖ Barriers that occur in the external environment.

Strategies to overcome the barriers of communication.

- ❖ Use of modern communication equipment.
- ❖ Imposing rules and regulations regarding communication
- ❖ Setting up communication towers.
- ❖ Use of digital technology
- ❖ Compilation of new rules and regulations on the misuse of communication methods

Advantages and Disadvantages of Different Communication Methods.

- ❖ Advantages of verbal communication media.
 - The ability to present a problem in greater detail and present it by discussion.
 - The provider and the receiver of the information become much closer.
 - The ability to present information fast and confidentially.
- ❖ Disadvantages of verbal communication media
 - The possibility of language problems.
 - Problems of exchanging information with parties who are verbally weak.
 - Non- existence of proof that the information is communicated.
- ❖ Advantages of written communication media
 - It is possible to provide information in greater detail.
 - Can be used as a proof for the transmission and receipt of the information.
 - It is possible to transmit data, notes, tables, graphs etc. easily.

- ❖ Disadvantages of written communication media
 - There can be difficulties in understanding the information.
 - If the recipient has reading difficulties the transmission of information becomes difficult.
 - The information may get distorted in the transmission process.

- ❖ Advantages of signs and symbols communication media
 - The ability to present information briefly and clearly.
 - The accuracy of the information being at a higher level
 - The ability to understand the information easily

- ❖ Disadvantages of signs and symbols communication media
 - There will be problems in exchanging information where the recipient suffers from a sight impairment.
 - If signs and symbols get distorted over time, miscommunication can occur.
 - It can be difficult to understand some signs and symbols.
 - The need for knowledge of signs and symbols before they are understood.